

Chapter 115-1

Liang Xinran naturally didn't leave.

Because Qiu Zimin fainted again.

Liang Xinzhou immediately carried Qiu Zimin back to her room upstairs and had Liang Xinhe call the family doctor.

This hour or so could only be described as a farce.

Liang Shi didn't bother anymore. She left this whole mess for Liang Xinzhou to clean up and had no intention of wading through these muddy waters again.

After saying goodbye to Liang Xinhe, she went out to the car.

The two little ones in the car were eagerly waiting for her return. Although cartoons were playing on the tablet, neither of them was in the mood to watch.

When Liang Shi came back, Ling Dang asked nervously, "Auntie, how did it go?"

Liang Shi patted her head. "Everything's fine. You little one, why don't you ever listen to adults?"

"Because adults lie." Ling Dang pouted. "There's obviously something wrong, but you won't tell me."

Liang Shi pulled her directly into her arms. "Your daddy is inside too. Do you want to go home with Daddy later or with me?"

"I have school tomorrow." Ling Dang sighed. "I'd better go with Daddy."

Liang Shi kissed her on her puffed-up cheek. "You're so well-behaved?"

Ling Dang nodded. "Of course~"

Her words were full of smugness.

Liang Shi chatted with her for a while, and before long, she brought up Shen Yiran from kindergarten again.

When talking about Shen Yiran, she wanted to pick a fight with Rainbow.

Rainbow, who had been peacefully watching cartoons, looked confused. "What?"

Ling Dang huffed lightly. "Don't try to steal Shen Yiran from me."

Rainbow: "...Why would you think I like her?"

Ling Dang immediately widened her eyes. "You actually don't like Shen Yiran?"

Rainbow: "...?"

Liang Shi found it amusing listening from the side. All the unpleasantness from the old mansion just now instantly vanished.

The two little ones were bickering in the back, so Liang Shi put on some music and took out her phone to play with.

There were no new messages, so she opened Weibo. Her Weibo account's followers were increasing every day—traffic brought by the "Mo Guang Mo Cai"¹ production team and Zhao Ying's side, as well as the red dress photos that had gone viral before.

Seeing the date of her last post and the comments below it, Liang Shi suddenly remembered that she should be doing some fan service².

But she wasn't someone who normally liked taking selfies, and she had no old photos on her phone to post on Weibo.

So she reluctantly opened her phone's front camera.

As it turned out, a beautiful face could handle a phone's front camera.

Because she was highly sensitive to cameras, she could almost find her most beautiful angle when taking photos. After taking the shot, she only needed to add a filter.

Without Sister Wang's urging and guidance, she could manage very decent fan service all by herself.

From taking photos to editing, it only took a few minutes, and then she posted on Weibo.

@Liang Shi: Going to join the production soon~ Pretty excited. How about you all?

A typical interactive post.

Talk about your current situation, then ask about the fans.

Supposedly this was better for cultivating fans.

Liang Shi wasn't someone who particularly liked cultivating fans, because she couldn't bear the consequences of fan backlash.

But fans could indirectly reflect a celebrity's commercial value. When sponsors chose celebrities for endorsements and promotions, they looked at commercial capability.

Liang Shi was good at acting, but she also needed to eat.

The money earned from purely acting might just be enough to support her staff, so she needed to develop other sources of income.

Back then, Sister Wang had poked her head and said, "Not earning money when you can—are you stupid? It's just posting a few Weibos. There's no shame in doing it to put food on the table. Besides, what's the big deal? They like you, you have such a beautiful face, what's wrong with posting a few photos for everyone to see? Can't you have some spirit of entertaining the public?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Shi was convinced.

As it turned out, she used to be spoiled.

When she was lazy, the captions for her Weibo posts were written by Xiao Bai. After filming all day, she was too tired, her mind was empty, and she couldn't think of any positive content at all. She was so drained she just wanted to sleep. The photos only looked so pretty because her face was beautiful.

And it was Xiao Bai who was responsible for taking her photos, shooting from a low angle, making her look beautiful from every angle.

Like she was going to compete with other actresses on the red carpet.

But now: "..."

She did everything herself. One person was an entire team.

Liang Shi wasn't considering building a team for now. Her current relaxed state was pretty good—work when there's work, rest when there isn't.

Handling everything by herself—freedom.

However, the previous Liang Shi had been criticized by rival fans³ for "pandering to fans" because she was so active with fan service.

It really disgusted Liang Shi.

At the time, she thought that people with dirty hearts see everything as dirty.

But because of what that person said, she posted multiple Weibos every day for three consecutive days—all kinds of selfies and daily life shares.

That was one of the few small rebellions in her career.

It was later put to an end by Sister Wang, because Sister Wang said posting too much on Weibo would dilute traffic and reduce commercial value.

Liang Shi: "..."

She learned something new again.

After she posted the Weibo, people quickly came to comment, though not many.

They came in twos and threes, but they were basically all compliments.

[Aww, who is this beautiful lady? I want cuddles.]

[Wifey is joining the production? I'm so excited too.]

[Looking forward to "Mo Guang Mo Cai"! May it be a big hit!]

...

Some IDs even had Zhao Ying's name in them—obviously they came to show support for Zhao Ying's sake.

Most of them were just fawning over her looks.

Liang Shi read for a while, then closed her phone.

Footnotes:

^1 Mo Guang Mo Cai (餘光): The name of the drama Liang Shi is about to film. The title literally means "afterglow" or "peripheral vision/remaining light."

^2 Fan service (營業, yíngyè): In the Chinese entertainment industry, this term literally means "doing business" but refers to celebrities interacting with fans through social media posts, selfies, and updates to maintain their popularity and engagement.

^3 Rival fans (對家, duìjiā): In Chinese fan culture, this refers to fans of competing celebrities who often clash with each other online. They may criticize or attack rival celebrities to elevate their own idol.

Chapter 115-2

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Minghui Jewelry.

Xu Qingzhu had just finished a meeting and was looking through the meeting materials when her phone vibrated slightly beside her. She glanced at it—it was a new notification from Weibo.

[Your special follow "Liang Shi" just posted on Weibo. Come check it out!]

Xu Qingzhu casually tapped in and saw Liang Shi's selfie.

The tone of the Weibo post was soft and cute.

This was Xu Qingzhu's secondary account. She had been using this account before she registered one with the ID "Xu Qingzhu."

That main public account had now accumulated nearly a million followers. In Su Meiqi's words, she had entered the ranks of minor internet celebrities and could be considered a public figure, so she needed to be careful about what she posted, liked, and followed on Weibo, lest someone with ulterior motives use it against her.

Moreover, that account was always full of little red notification dots whenever she logged in. As someone with OCD, she couldn't stand seeing those, so now she basically only logged into this account.

Unless the company had something to promote and needed her to repost a Weibo, she would log into the main one.

Like when they officially announced Yang Shuyan as a brand ambassador before.

The ID of this account was "Upward Growing Bamboo."^1

After seeing the IDs of the fans under Liang Shi's Weibo post, Xu Qingzhu went and bought a membership to change her name.

At first, she didn't know what name to change to. Then she happened to see someone with the ID "Sitting in Liang Shi's Arms" and another with the ID "Sleeping with Liang Shi Tonight."

Xu Qingzhu typed in the name change box: ShiRuPoZhu_szd.^2

It didn't look particularly aesthetic.

But it was sneakily meaningful.

It was also because of Yang Shuyan that Xu Qingzhu had gained a new understanding of fan circle culture.

For example, when fans called celebrities "wife," they didn't actually mean wife. They always went wild with their words online, relying on the fact that celebrities couldn't see them, going absolutely crazy—like driving a Mercedes-Benz and daring to race on Mount Akina.^3

After changing her ID, Xu Qingzhu went to Liang Shi's Weibo and scrolled through all the comments.

While her eyes were still scanning the documents, she was thinking about what comment to leave.

By the time she finished one page of documents, she had figured it out.

[@ShiRuPoZhu_szd: Wifey, I love you.]

[@ShiRuPoZhu_szd: Wifey, you're so beautiful today.]

[@ShiRuPoZhu_szd: I really want to dance on wifey's collarbone.]

Having been in fan circles for half a month, she hadn't learned anything else, but she picked up flirty talk immediately.

But this was still her first time putting it into practice.

Xu Qingzhu posted these comments with an expressionless face, placed her phone face-down on the desk, and continued reading the documents.

But after browsing a few more lines, she received another message. It was a WeChat from Liang Shi: [Photo.jpg]

It was a picture of Ling Dang glaring fiercely at Rainbow.

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

For a moment, Xu Qingzhu had held some hope.

She thought she would see an updated selfie from Liang Shi, at least on the same level as the one on Weibo. Instead, she only saw two kids.

Hmm, the girlfriend fans on Weibo got benefits.

The actual wife got nothing.

Xu Qingzhu stared at the screen for a while, thinking about how to reply, when Liang Shi sent another video.

The video was seven seconds long. When Xu Qingzhu opened it, she heard Rainbow say, "Can you not be so childish?"

Ling Dang crossed her arms and huffed lightly. "Hmph! Sheng Yu said if you're not childish, then don't go to kindergarten with us!"

Rainbow: "But kindergarten isn't for you to date."

Ling Dang: "...We're not dating."

A few seconds later, Ling Dang said matter-of-factly, "We're married!"

At the end of the video, there was the sound of Liang Shi laughing.

Xu Qingzhu was dying of laughter at these two little brats' conversation. She pressed the voice message button and said, "Ask Ling Dang when she's having her wedding. Auntie will give her gift money."⁴

Liang Shi quickly replied, "Ling Dang says she'll have it after kindergarten graduation. She also asks what gift money is."

Xu Qingzhu said, "Let your auntie explain it. This auntie can't explain it clearly."

It took a while for Liang Shi to reply—she had probably gone to explain it to Ling Dang.

This time she sent back a screenshot.

It showed three comments, and the commenter's ID was "ShiRuPoZhu_szd."

Liang Shi: [I searched everywhere but couldn't find which two celebrities this CP name is for, but I feel like...]

Xu Qingzhu: [Hm? What is this?]

Her secondary account was basically empty. The only activity was liking other people's Weibos.

And the likes were all for current events news. Occasionally she would show up under celebrity topics, but she only liked some funny comments.

So there was no way to figure out who owned this account through these.

Xu Qingzhu chose to play dumb.

Footnotes:

¹ "Upward Growing Bamboo" (向上生長的竹子): The Chinese word for bamboo (竹子, zhúzi) contains the character 竹 (zhú), which is also in Xu Qingzhu's name (許清竹). This is her subtle way of incorporating her identity into her username.

² "ShiRuPoZhu_szd" (勢如破竹szd): This is a Chinese idiom meaning "like splitting bamboo" or "with irresistible force," describing overwhelming momentum. However, it cleverly contains "Shi" (勢, which sounds like Liang Shi's name 适) and "Zhu" (竹, bamboo, from Xu Qingzhu's name). The "szd" is internet slang for "是真的" (shì zhēn de), meaning "it's real/true." So the name secretly represents their couple name while appearing to be just an idiom.

³ Mount Akina (秋名山): A reference to the famous mountain pass from the Japanese manga/anime "Initial D," known for illegal street racing. The phrase implies recklessly doing something dangerous or outrageous while feeling invincible.

⁴ Gift money (份子錢, fènzǐ qián): In Chinese culture, guests give monetary gifts in red envelopes to newlyweds at weddings. The amount given is typically recorded and reciprocated when the gift-giver has their own celebration.

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Liang Shi: [It's in my comment section. I just posted on Weibo, and then I saw this ID.]

Xu Qingzhu: [What about it? It's just an idiom, right?]

Liang Shi: [...No, the abbreviation after it means "it's real." I think it's the name of some CP fans.]

Xu Qingzhu: [Oh? So that's what it is.]

Seeing that she didn't know, Liang Shi didn't continue.

But Xu Qingzhu asked: [So which CP is it?]

Liang Shi: [I couldn't find it, but I keep feeling like it's...]

She stopped mid-sentence.

Xu Qingzhu asked: [Like what?]

Liang Shi: [Never mind, it's nothing.]

Xu Qingzhu: [...Why do you always say things halfway?]

Liang Shi: [Shi—Shi, Zhu, ShiRuPoZhu (like splitting bamboo)... it really seems like a CP name for you and me.]

Since you can't see expressions when typing anyway, Liang Shi's hands trembled a little as she typed.

Then she sent a sticker.

It was one she had just saved from Zhao Ying—a little bear saying "I love U."

It was a very straightforward expression of simple affection.

Xu Qingzhu looked at the screen and quickly took a screenshot. Two seconds later, the screen displayed: "Liang Shi recalled a message."

Xu Qingzhu immediately sent the sticker back out.

Plus two heart-gesture stickers.

All stolen from Sally.

Xu Qingzhu: [Have you never seen stickers before? Here, have a few more.]

Then countless stickers flooded the screen, all saying "I love you."

There were also various anime-style GIFs of hugging and kissing, pinning against a wall and kissing, kissing on the sofa, and kissing in the kitchen.

Liang Shi: [...Teacher Xu, what do you look at every day?]

Liang Shi: [Who are you chatting with?]

Liang Shi: [Where did you steal these stickers from?]

Xu Qingzhu replied shamelessly: [Sally. She also sends me pictures of big boobs. Want to see?]

Liang Shi: [...]

A few seconds later, Liang Shi sent Sally a message: [You! Stop sending Xu Qingzhu those indecent things in the future. NeedOxygen.jpg]

Sally, who was in the middle of working, looked confused. She turned around and sent the screenshot to Xu Qingzhu: [What???]

Xu Qingzhu: [My wife says you shouldn't send me pictures of big boobs. Indecent.]

Xu Qingzhu: [Reflect on yourself.]

Sally: [???

Sally complained aggrievedly in the three-person group chat with Lin Luoxi: [@Lin Luoxi, babe, Blanche is bullying me.]

Lin Luoxi: [Babe my ass. Slacking off at work. Docking your pay.]

Sally: [Blanche is bullying me just because she has a wife. She was clearly the one who was curious about my stickers.]

Lin Luoxi: [Maybe you should behave yourself. Don't you know what kind of stuff is in your sticker collection? Why did you send them to Zhuzi? Do you have a death wish?]

Sally: [...Sorry babe, I'll kneel when I get home.]

Lin Luoxi: [I'm not coming home tonight. Kneel however you want.]

Sally: [@Lin Luoxi, are you really going to abandon me and leave me alone in an empty room?]

"Xu Qingzhu invited Liang Shi to join the group chat."

Sally: [? What for?]

Xu Qingzhu: [I don't want to eat dog food.]^1

Sally: [?]

Liang Shi: [@Sally, please maintain a three-meter distance from my wife, thank you.]

Liang Shi: [If you have something to say, say it to me, thank you.]

Sally: [Fuck! @Lin Luoxi, babe, let's get married! I want a wife too.]

Lin Luoxi: [Sorry everyone, let me drag away my crazy dog first.]

"Lin Luoxi has removed Sally from the group chat."

Xu Qingzhu was reading documents while chatting casually with them in the group. It was mainly Sally who was livening up the atmosphere in the group.

Footnotes:

^{^1} "Eating dog food" (吃狗糧, chī gǒu liáng): Chinese internet slang for being forced to witness public displays of affection between couples. Similar to the English expression "third-wheeling" but specifically refers to seeing couples being lovey-dovey.

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Sally had a carefree personality and would never get angry no matter how people joked with her.

Everyone had loved joking with her since their university days.

After Liang Shi joined the group, she only said a few things. After some back and forth, they made plans to go drinking with Sally.

Xu Qingzhu wanted to laugh just thinking about how Liang Shi looked when she was drunk. Every time before drinking, she was confident she could handle three bottles, but then she'd pass out after three glasses.

Meanwhile, in her chat with Liang Shi, Xu Qingzhu sent: [So what did you post on Weibo?]

Liang Shi obediently sent a screenshot: [Just a photo. Fan service.]

Xu Qingzhu: [And then fans were asking for kisses, hugs, and to be lifted up high?]

Liang Shi: [...]

Xu Qingzhu: [Who would have thought, Teacher Liang is quite popular.]

Liang Shi: [...]

Xu Qingzhu: [That fan actually wants to dance on your collarbone. I want to passionately kiss your abs.]

Liang Shi: [...]

She sent an emergency stop sticker. [I don't have abs right now. I will in a while.
Expressionless.jpg]

Xu Qingzhu: [Teacher Liang doesn't have abs, but she has collarbones. The perks female celebrities give their fans really are something else.]

Liang Shi: [...]

She felt that if this topic continued to develop, it might get out of control.

So she took the initiative to change the subject. [Why aren't you asking me how things went at the Liang family?]

Xu Qingzhu stared at the screen in silence for a few seconds, then couldn't help herself and pressed the voice message button. "How could it have gone? You, Big Brother, Second Brother—none of you are a match for her."

Liang Shi: "..."

"You've already been reduced to sitting in the car comforting children, so obviously nothing got accomplished." Xu Qingzhu's tone was somewhat flippant, a bit like how she sounded when talking to Xu Qingya. She paused mid-sentence. "Let me guess—she pulled out her ultimate move and said she was leaving, right? And then the three of you had no idea what to do?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She practically wanted to praise Xu Qingzhu as a fortune teller.

With an eager-to-learn attitude, Liang Shi proactively asked: [President Xu, what should we do now?]

When it came to dealing with green tea bitches^{^1}, Liang Shi was naturally at a disadvantage.

At first, she couldn't see through a green tea's tactics. Now, she didn't know how to deal with them.

She could match acting skills with her, but Qiu Zimin definitely wouldn't believe it.

Besides, Liang Shi didn't want to act in front of Qiu Zimin. It would be a waste of emotion.

She needed a simple and crude effective method.

Xu Qingzhu poked at her screen: [Wait, let me ask Lin Luoxi for you. She's an expert in this area.]

Liang Shi: [...]

No wonder Xu Qingzhu knew so much. Turns out she had experts around her.

A few seconds later, Xu Qingzhu sent Liang Shi a voice message. "Don't go up there and try to out-green-tea her yourself. Let Big Brother do it. If she wants to play the victim for sympathy—that's her usual online routine—then have Big Brother say that the Liang family hasn't had it easy over the years either, how hard everyone worked, that kind of thing. Play the victim right back at her. If she wants to leave, have Big Brother say some polite words—after all, you're still family, distance won't make you distant, but the family really can't manage right now. Wanwan cried all night over losing her sketchbook and almost ended up in the hospital. Ling Dang was also humiliated at the hospital."

Xu Qingzhu sent two full sixty-second voice messages.

She passionately strategized for Liang Shi. After listening, Liang Shi summarized it into one point: when dealing with someone playing the victim, you have to act even more pitiful than her.

If someone is being a green tea to you, then you green tea right back.

Of course, this was assuming you had someone backing you up.

Xu Qingzhu also attached Lin Luoxi's exclusive manual: if no one is backing you up and you encounter a green tea who plays the victim, then just go up and slap her.

Lin Luoxi's original words were: Slap her mouth to pieces. You're going to get a bad reputation anyway, so you might as well enjoy yourself first.

After hearing this, Liang Shi found it a bit hard to look at Lin Luoxi the same way.

But she had to admit, this method was very effective.

Just as she was about to give Big Brother some advice, she saw Big Brother carrying Liang Xinran's suitcase, with Liang Xinran following behind him as they walked out of the old mansion.

Liang Xinran looked like she was about to cry behind him, while Liang Xinzhou walked expressionlessly in front.

Liang Shi immediately got out of the car and called out, "Big Brother, where are you going?"

Liang Xinzhou pressed his lips together and said coldly, "Sending Xinran away."

Footnotes:

^1 Green tea bitch (綠茶, lǜ chá): Chinese internet slang for a woman who appears innocent, pure, and harmless on the surface but is actually manipulative and scheming underneath. The term comes from the idea that green tea looks pure and refreshing but can have a bitter aftertaste. "To green tea someone" means to use these manipulative tactics against them.